The solution lay in the Charter of the United Nations, in accordance with which the Arabs of Palestine, who constituted the majority, were entitled to a free and independent state. … Once Palestine was found to be entitled to independence, the United Nations was not legally competent to decide or impose the constitutional organisation of Palestine, since such action would amount to interference with an internal matter of an independent nation.

Source D

Palestinian Jewish views of the UNSCOP proposals for partition were conveyed to the UN by Rabbi Hillel Silver of the Jewish Agency for Palestine, October 1947.

The plan proposed that the city of Jerusalem should be established as a separate unit. But modern Jerusalem contained a compact Jewish community of 90,000 inhabitants, and included the central national, religious and educational institutions of the Jewish people of Palestine. … It was the ancient capital of the Jewish nation and its symbol throughout the ages. … If that heavy sacrifice was the inescapable condition of a final solution … then the Jewish Agency was prepared to recommend the acceptance of the partition solution … subject to further discussion of constitutional and territorial provisions.

Source E

Extract from: A History of Modern Palestine*, 2004, by Ilan Pappe, a 'revisionist' Israeli historian.*

The Palestinian refusal to accept a UN solution provided a pretext [excuse or given reason] for implementing a systematic expulsion of the local population within the areas allocated for a Jewish state, areas already demarcated in the UNSCOP report. … Twelve days after the adoption of the UN resolution [in November 1947], the expulsion of Palestinians began. A month later, the first Palestinian village was wiped out by Jewish retaliation to a Palestinian attack on convoys and Jewish settlements. This action was transformed into an ethnic cleansing operation in March, which resulted in the loss to Palestine of much of its indigenous [original] population.

(a) (i) What, according to Source A, might lessen Arab opposition to partition? (2 marks)
(ii) What is the message of Source D? (3 marks)
(b) In what ways does the message of Source B support the views expressed in Source A? (6 marks)
(c) With reference to their origin and purpose, assess the value and limitations of Sources C and E for historians studying the origins of the Israeli–Palestinian conflict. (6 marks)
(d) Using these sources and your own knowledge, explain to what extent you agree with the view that it was the Palestinian Arab refusal to accept the UN partition plan that led to increased conflict in Palestine. (8 marks)